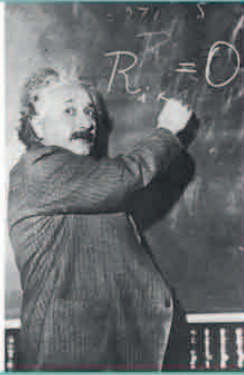


REAL WORLD

Eureka!

Albert Einstein is reputed to have uttered the interjection *Eureka!* on coming up with his special theory of relativity. *Eureka* is a Greek word, meaning “I have found it.” Similar moments of revelation may be marked by interjections like *aha!* or *hooray!*—the benefit being that a single-word interjection conveys much more emotion than a simple sentence.



Greetings

Everyday greetings like *hello*, *hi*, *goodbye*, and even *yoo-hoo* are interjections, functioning on their own or as part of a sentence. Like other interjections, if a greeting is removed from a sentence, the meaning of that sentence is not affected.

Hello, what are you doing?



This interjection is used to mean “be quiet!”

Shh! I’m concentrating.



Interruptions and introductions

Many English speakers use the interjections *er* or *um* to fill pauses in their speech, such as when they are unsure of what to say. These are sometimes called hesitation devices. *Yes*, *no*, and variations of the two are also interjections, as are other introductory expressions such as *indeed* and *well*. These can be used alone in response to a question or statement.

I, **er**, have no idea what has happened to, **um**, the snake charmer.

Commas are used on either side of a mild interjection such as a hesitation device if it appears in the middle of a sentence.

Yes, he’s been gone for ages. Where is he?

The interjections *yes* and *no* are used at the start of a sentence, followed by a comma, or on their own.

Asides

Interjections are often used in parentheses to indicate an aside or an action. This is particularly useful in a play script, because it indicates the tone of a sentence and gives directions to the actors.

The snake charmer is (**cough!**) temporarily unavailable.

This aside tells the speaker to pause and cough—in this case, indicating that the speaker doesn’t necessarily believe what he or she is saying.

